UX CASE STUDY · PRODUCT STRATEGY

VELOCITY REWARDS MVP

Designing a petrol-retail rewards experience for Shell stations around the real rhythm of a fuel stop: visible value, flexible redemption, intentional tipping.

Johannesburg pilot · Card-agnostic · Cashless

ROLE	DESIGNER	SCOPE
UX Designer, individual	Stanslous Nhau	Audit → MVP → hi-fi UI

STATUS
Self-directed concept

This case study covers

- ✓ Problem & opportunity
- ✓ Process
- ✓ Research & competitor audit
- ✓ Archetypes & persona
- ✓ MVP definition
- ✓ Trade-offs
- ✓ Design decisions
- ✓ Journey & digital flow
- ✓ Low fidelity
- ✓ High fidelity
- ✓ Visual design system
- ✓ Success & impact
- ✓ Lessons & next steps

> // Single contributor: I took Velocity from research to hi-fi screens on my own.

01 PROBLEM & OPPORTUNITY

01 · PROBLEM & OPPORTUNITY

REWARDS CUSTOMERS CAN’T SEE GET ABANDONED.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Motorists who refuel at Shell in Johannesburg earn points on a card they rarely carry and a balance they never see. Value is hard to use, tied to one card or partner, and there is no digital way to tip the attendant. The programme loses the repeat visits it exists to earn.

How might we make rewards visible and usable without slowing the fuel stop?

02 PROCESS

02 · PROCESS

HOW I WORKED.

1. **Discover** Competitor & market audit
2. **Define** Archetypes & hypotheses
3. **Ideate** MVP definition & trade-offs
4. **Design** Flow, screens & visual system

03 RESEARCH

03 · RESEARCH

VISIBILITY DRIVES ENGAGEMENT.

Competitor and market audit in place of interviews. Findings are directional, not validated.

PROGRAMME	HIGHLIGHTS	CARD-AGNOSTIC	CASHLESS, INSTANT REDEMPTION	BUILT-IN TIPPING
Sasol Rewards	Simple, trusted earn rate; wide network	–	–	✓
BP Rewards	Stacks with Smart Shopper; tangible cashback	✕	–	✕
Engen 1App	Depends on partner cards; unclear point tracking	–	–	✓
eBucks	Deep bank integration; high ceiling for top tiers	✕	✓	✕
Discovery Vitality	Up to 50% fuel cashback via driving score	✕	–	✕
Tappy	Solves cashless attendant tipping, standalone	✓	✓	✓

✕ Poor / not offered · – Partial · ✓ Strong / fully offered

Audit lens

01 **01 Visibility** Can customers see what they’ve earned, straight away?

02 **02 Usable value** Can points become something useful, easily?

03 **03 Tipping integration** Is there a clear digital way to thank the attendant?

04 **04 Redemption flexibility** Can customers choose when and where to redeem?

What the audit suggests

01 **Visibility** Low visibility into points was the biggest driver of disengagement.

02 **Flexibility** Options buried three or four menus deep aren’t flexibility.

03 **Integrated tipping** No programme lets customers tip from rewards in one journey.

04 ARCHETYPES

04 · ARCHETYPES

THREE ARCHETYPES, ONE SHARED NEED: CONTROL.

Hypotheses from market patterns, not interview-based personas.

01 **Lindiwe Sibanda, 45** Value-conscious parent. Refuels 2–3× weekly, switches card and cash.
“If it saves us money on the school run, we’re in.”

02 **Lesego Molefe, 32** Time-pressed commuter. Apple Pay or card, hates log-ins.
“Make it quick or I’m out.”

03 **Jabulani Dube, 35** Bolt driver, daily top-ups, tips in cash.
“An easier way to thank them digitally, I’d do it all the time.”

Persona in detail

LINDIWE SIBANDA

The Balance- and Value-Conscious Parent

45 · Associate Consultant · 2 children · Debit card, some cash

“If it saves us money on the school run and the weekend wash, we’re in.”

HYPOTHESIS PERSONA
Drawn from market patterns, not interviews.

BEHAVIOURS
- Refuels 2–3× a week, kids in the car
- Buys kids’ snacks at the store
- Switches card and cash

GOALS
- Redeem across fuel, wash, kiosk
- Track the family balance
- Stretch the budget

FRUSTRATIONS
- Restrictions that ignore real habits
- Confusing points-to-value maths
- Rewards tied to one card

MOTIVATIONS
- Flexible use across services
- Transparency and fairness
- Value that is easy to grasp

DELIGHTERS
- “Worth up to R125” visible the moment she opens the app
- One family balance she can track at a glance
- Using points on a car wash or kiosk treat during the same stop

EMOTIONAL DRIVERS
- Feeling in control of the family budget
- Fairness: no hidden rules or surprise expiry
- Pride in stretching the rand for her kids

DECISION MAKING
- Weighs value in rand, not in points
- Pays with whatever is in her wallet that day
- Keeps a programme only if its value is easy to see

Delighters, drivers and decision patterns are hypotheses extrapolated from the market audit, to be validated in interviews.

Shared need

01 **Control: payment** Which payment method is used.

02 **Control: redemption** Where value can be redeemed.

03 **Control: generosity** How thanks is expressed.

Tension to test: Lesego won’t spend effort on an app at the pump, yet the MVP is app-based. The bet: one glance at a visible balance replaces card juggling. Task tests must time this at the pump.

05 MVP DEFINITION

05 · MVP DEFINITION

FOUR BEHAVIOURS, NOT A LONG FEATURE LIST.

If a hypothesis fails, that behaviour is cut or reshaped, not defended.

01 **See it** One unified, visible balance.

02 **Use it now** Redeem or withdraw close to the moment it’s earned.

03 **Pay my way** Earning stays card-agnostic.

04 **Thank clearly** Tipping separate from fuel, with recipient and amount explicit.

H1 Visibility lifts return · H2 Card-agnostic matters · H3 Cash-out is valued · H4 Tipping belongs here

> // If it does not help at the pump, it does not belong in the MVP.

06 TRADE-OFFS

06 · TRADE-OFFS

FLEXIBILITY MATTERS, BUT THE STOP MUST STAY FAST.

DECISION	TRADE-OFF	MVP CALL
Card-agnostic earning	Flexibility vs simplicity	Clear earning flow first; validate station payment compatibility before expanding.
Use rewards now	Redemption vs value control	Transparent balances and defined rules, limiting fraud and liability.
Digital tipping	Generosity vs checkout friction	Optional, quick, confirmed, with amount and recipient visible.
Four core behaviours	Breadth vs adoption	Defer advanced features until station pilots show they work.

> // Preserve customer choice without adding steps to the moment of purchase.

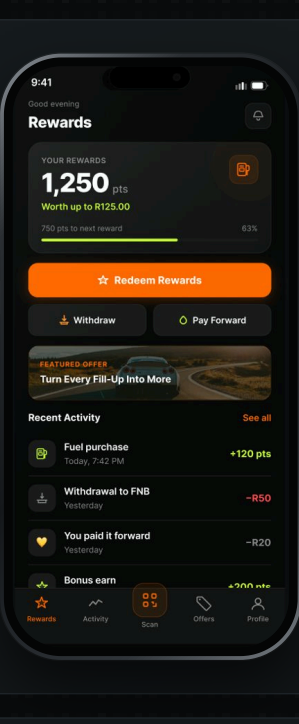
07 DESIGN DECISIONS

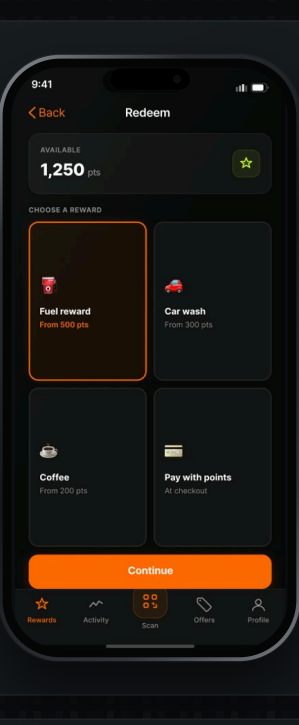
07 · DESIGN DECISIONS

KEY DECISIONS, WITH THE SCREENS THAT PROVE THEM.

01 SEE IT

DECISION Fuel and in-store purchases feed one visible points balance.
REJECTED Separate fuel and shop wallets mirroring Shell’s structure.
EFFECT One number reinforces a “one programme” model.



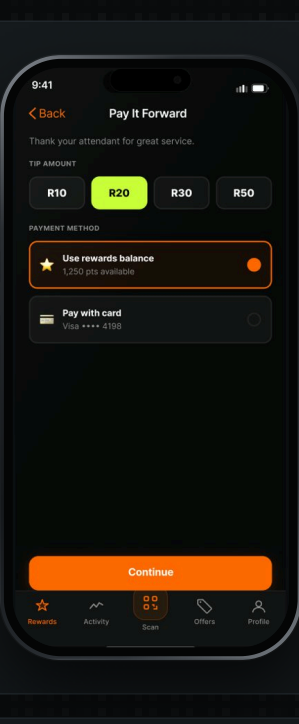


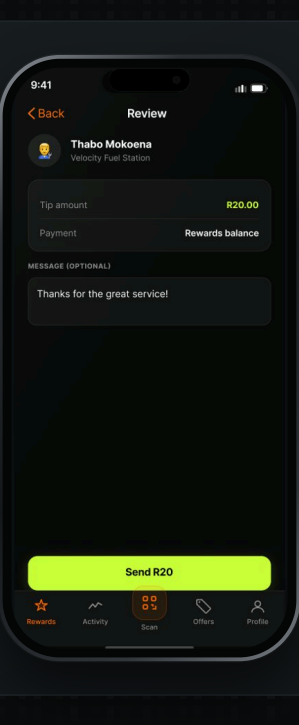
02 USE IT NOW

DECISION Redeem or withdraw close to the moment it’s earned.
REJECTED High thresholds, delayed rewards, restricted catalogues.
EFFECT Shortens the distance between behaviour and benefit.

03 PAY MY WAY

DECISION Earning stays payment-agnostic.
REJECTED A bank-linked or single-card structure.
EFFECT Broadens participation; Shell, not a bank, stays central.





04 THANK CLEARLY

DECISION Tipping is separate from fuel, with recipient and amount explicit.
REJECTED A purely transactional journey; gratuity bundled invisibly.
EFFECT Keeps the human layer while supporting a cashless future.

Try it: slide your rewards

REDEEM FUEL · WITHDRAW CASH · PAY IT FORWARD

FUEL VALUE
R 50.00
500 pts used · 750 pts left

R5 — R100

A QR code is valid for 5 minutes at the pump.

Illustrative: 10 points = R1, as in the prototype (1,250 points is worth up to R125).

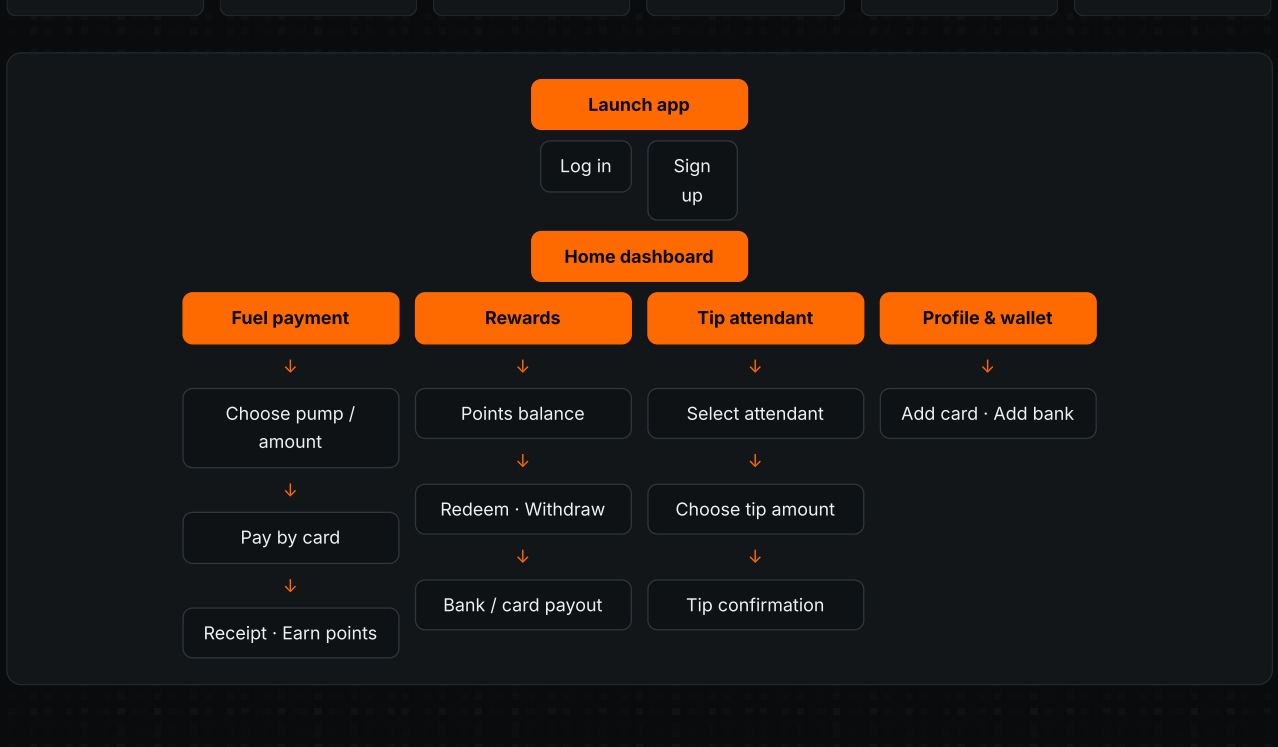
08 JOURNEY

08 · JOURNEY

ONE FUEL STOP, A SMOOTHER REWARDS EXPERIENCE.

The digital flow mirrors the station: Launch → Sign in → Dashboard → Fuel payment, Rewards, Tipping, Wallet.

1 Arrive	2 Pay	3 Fuel & earn	4 See value	5 Redeem	6 Thank
Pull in, pick a pump	Choose any method	Points earned, no extra task	+250 pts, balance visible	Choose when and where	Optional digital tip

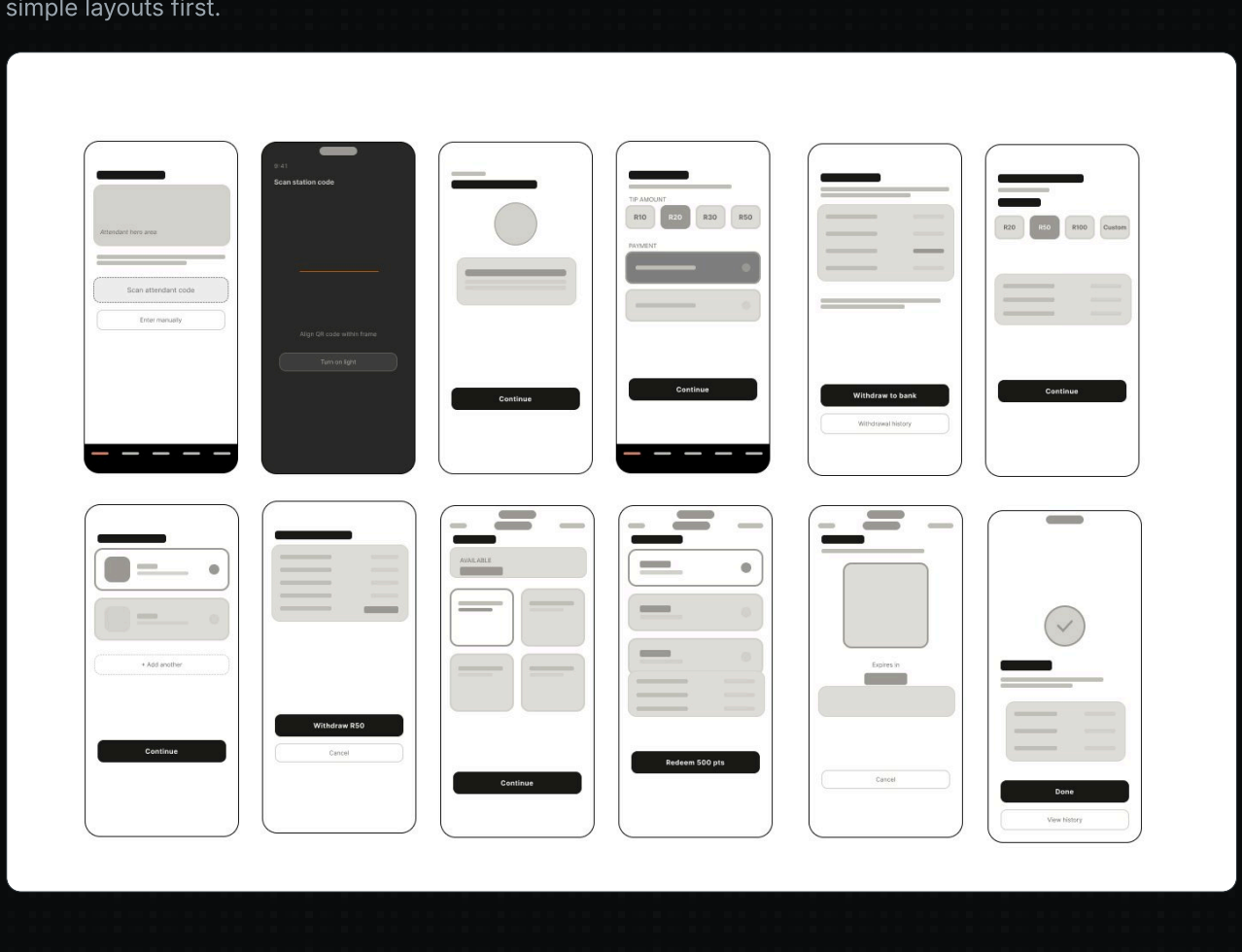


09 LOW FIDELITY

09 · LOW FIDELITY

CORE TASKS BEFORE VISUALS.

Attendant identification, payment, rewards, withdrawal and redemption, tested as simple layouts first.



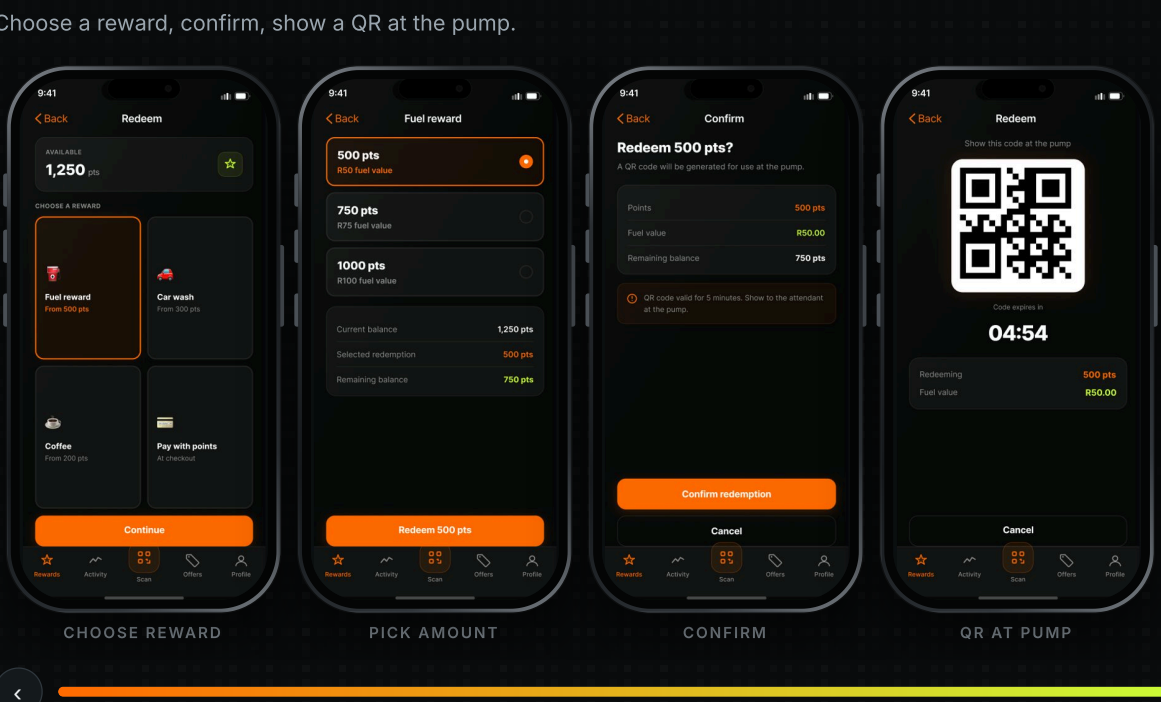
10 HIGH FIDELITY

10 · HIGH FIDELITY

THREE FLOWS, ONE BALANCE.

REDEEM

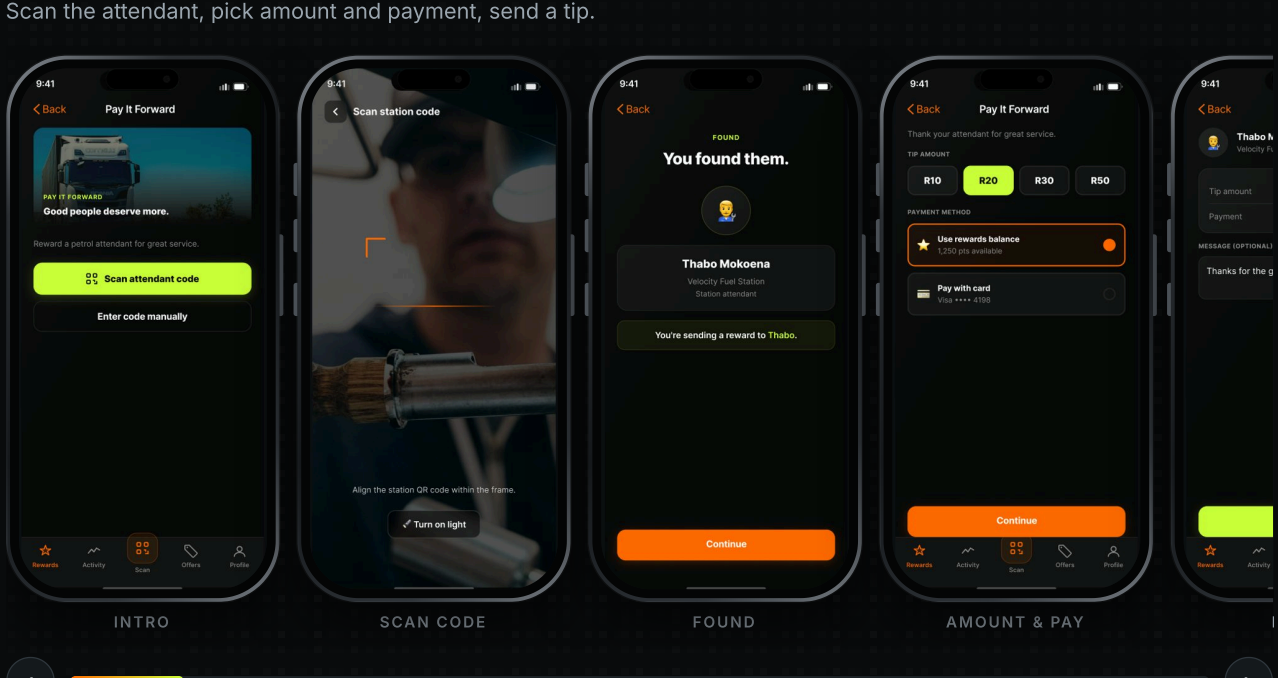
Choose a reward, confirm, show a QR at the pump.



CHOOSE REWARD · PICK AMOUNT · CONFIRM · QR AT PUMP

PAY IT FORWARD

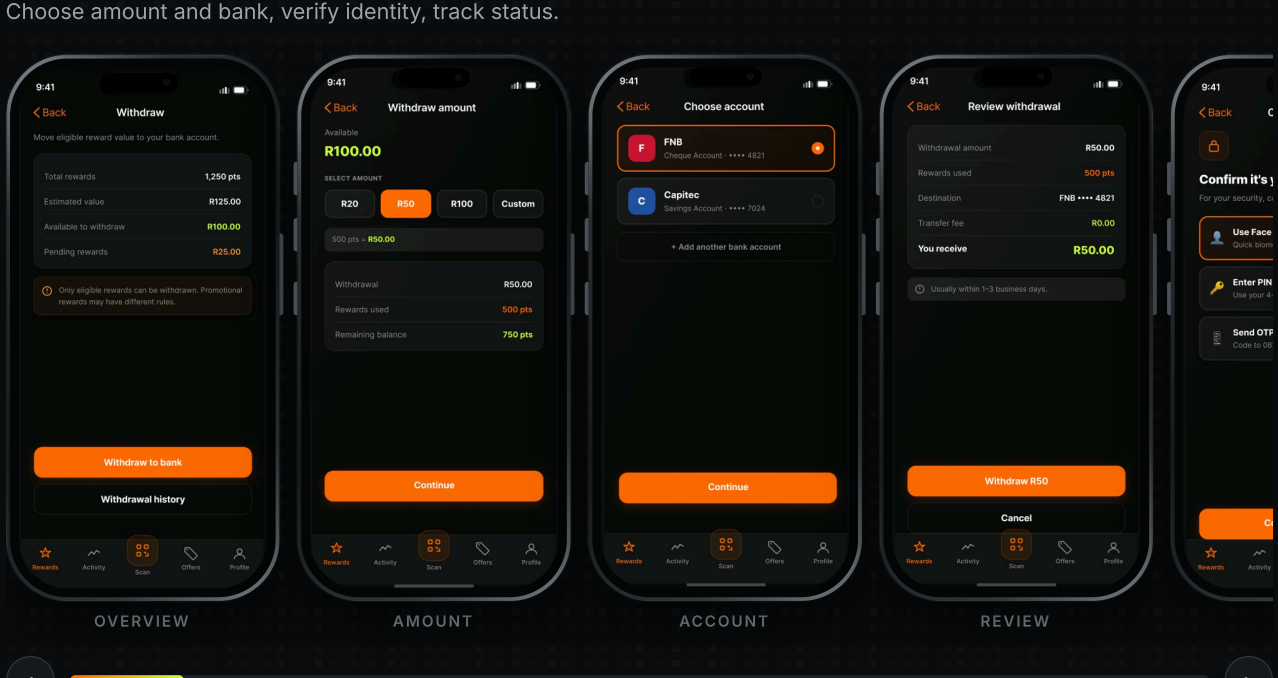
Scan the attendant, pick amount and payment, send a tip.



INTRO · SCAN CODE · FOUND · AMOUNT & PAY

WITHDRAW

Choose amount and bank, verify identity, track status.



OVERVIEW · AMOUNT · ACCOUNT · REVIEW

11 VISUAL DESIGN SYSTEM

11 · VISUAL DESIGN SYSTEM

DARK, HIGH-CONTRAST, BUILT FOR THE FORECOURT.

Orange	Lime	Amber	Error	Background	Text
#FF6A00	#C9FF38	#FF9A2F	#FF4D4D	#080A09	#FFFFFF
Action, fuel	Rewards, success	Pending	Failures, debits	Surface	Copy

TYPOGRAPHY
Aa
Inter

BORDER RADIUS

SPACING · BASE 4PX

12 SUCCESS & IMPACT

12 · SUCCESS & IMPACT

SUCCESS IS REPEAT VISITS.

PRIMARY MEASURE

30/60-day return

Against a pre-pilot baseline. Repeat engagement tests whether visibility and control create habit: the experience should earn another stop.

01 **Secondary: redemption** Proves the flow works, not that customers return.

01 **Rejected: sign-ups** Curiosity can be bought; it doesn’t prove behaviour changed.

13 LESSONS & NEXT STEPS

13 · LESSONS & NEXT STEPS

WHAT I’D CARRY FORWARD.

01 **Evidence has a ceiling** An audit without interviews is directional. Saying so early shaped my hypotheses and the rule that a failed one gets cut or reshaped.

02 **Every choice costs a step** Each time I added flexibility (payment, redemption, tipping) I asked what it did to the moment at the pump.

03 **Pick the metric before the pixels** Choosing repeat engagement over sign-ups first kept the design honest about what success means.

Next steps

01 Interviews	02 Task tests	03 Live pilot	04 Iterate
Test H1–H4	Balance, redeem, tip	Return, service time, cost	Keep what earns a visit

> // I used imperfect evidence to make a precise design bet, then defined how I would prove or disprove it.

THANK YOU FOR READING MY CASE STUDY

Hope you enjoyed the ride.

PAY IT FORWARD
R 0.00

TIP THE AUTHOR

Tank’s full. Rewards redeemed. See you at the next stop.

Stanslous Nhau · UX Designer · Johannesburg, South Africa

Self-directed concept informed by a market audit. Archetypes are hypotheses; success measures need customer, commercial and station validation.